

CRAM SHEET

The Eight Extraordinary Vessels — Qi Jing Ba Mai

GV 28 pts · CV 24 pts · Chong/Dai/Qiao×2/Wei×2 share primary points

Quiz Ready — Quiz 6

Only 2 Have Points

GV (28) + CV (24)
the other 6 share pts

4 Confluent Pairs

8 points total
master-couple system

Zero Organs

no zang/fu pertaining
no interior-exterior pair

+ Confluent pairs table · one-source-three-branches · Quiz 5 MAINT review · Homework 5 rubric

The 4 Confluent (Master-Couple) Pairs

Chong Mai + Yin Wei Mai

SP 4 Gongsun

× PC 6 Neiguan

Stomach, heart, chest -- Gongsun opens Chong, Neiguan opens Yin Wei; combine to treat chest/epigastric/cardiac patterns.

Du Mai + Yang Qiao Mai

SI 3 Houxi

× BL 62 Shenmai

Inner canthus, neck, ear, shoulder -- spinal stiffness/pain, febrile disease, mental disorders.

Ren Mai + Yin Qiao Mai

LU 7 Lieque

× KI 6 Zhaohai

Lung, throat, chest, diaphragm -- cough, sore throat, chest tightness.

Dai Mai + Yang Wei Mai

GB 41 Zulinqi

× SJ 5 Waiguan

Outer canthus, ear, cheek, neck, shoulder -- lateral-body pain, febrile disease, exterior patterns.

“ONE SOURCE, THREE BRANCHES” (Yi Yuan San Qi)

Du Mai, Ren Mai, and Chong Mai all arise from inside the lower abdomen and emerge together at the perineum before diverging into three separate pathways -- Du posteriorly along the spine, Ren anteriorly along the abdomen/chest, Chong internally along the spine with a superficial branch beside the Kidney meridian. Chinese: Yi Yuan San Qi -- “one source, three branches.”

THE DEFINING TRAIT

None of the Eight Extraordinary Vessels pertains to a zang or fu organ, and none has an interior-exterior paired relationship the way the 12 primary meridians do. Only Du Mai (GV) and Ren Mai (CV) have their own dedicated acupuncture points -- the other six vessels borrow points from the primary meridians they cross (their “coalescent points,” Jiao Hui Xue).

“SEA” TITLES

Du Mai (GV):	sea of the YANG meridians
Ren Mai (CV):	sea of the YIN meridians
Chong Mai:	sea of 12 meridians · blood · zang-fu organs

All 8 Vessels at a Glance

Governor Vessel (Du Mai) <i>Sea of the Yang Meridians</i>	28 pts (own) Coalescent: 2	Confluent: SI 3 Houxi <i>pairs BL 62 Shenmai (Yang Qiao Mai)</i>
Conception Vessel (Ren Mai) <i>Sea of the Yin Meridians</i>	24 pts (own) Coalescent: 2	Confluent: LU 7 Lieque <i>pairs KI 6 Zhaohai (Yin Qiao Mai)</i>
Thoroughfare Vessel (Chong Mai) <i>Sea of the 12 Meridians · Sea of Blood · Sea of the Zang-Fu Organs</i>	shares primary pts Coalescent: 14	Confluent: SP 4 Gongsun <i>pairs PC 6 Neiguan (Yin Wei Mai)</i>
Belt Vessel (Dai Mai) <i>The Binding/Girdling Vessel (not a "sea")</i>	shares primary pts Coalescent: 3	Confluent: GB 41 Zulinqi <i>pairs SJ 5 Waiguan (Yang Wei Mai)</i>
Yang Heel Vessel (Yang Qiao Mai)	shares primary pts Coalescent: 10	Confluent: BL 62 Shenmai <i>pairs SI 3 Houxi (Du Mai)</i>
Yin Heel Vessel (Yin Qiao Mai)	shares primary pts Coalescent: 3	Confluent: KI 6 Zhaohai <i>pairs LU 7 Lieque (Ren Mai)</i>
Yang Link Vessel (Yang Wei Mai)	shares primary pts Coalescent: 14	Confluent: SJ 5 Waiguan <i>pairs GB 41 Zulinqi (Dai Mai)</i>
Yin Link Vessel (Yin Wei Mai)	shares primary pts Coalescent: 7	Confluent: PC 6 Neiguan <i>pairs SP 4 Gongsun (Chong Mai)</i>

UNRESOLVED DISCREPANCIES (do not silently resolve):

Yang Qiao Mai: slide header says "(12)" coalescent points, only 10 named. FLAGGED.

Yang Wei Mai: slide header says "(15)" coalescent points, only 14 named. FLAGGED.

QUIZ 5 MAINT REVIEW (from Dr. Zhang's live review, per transcript)

- PC's pertaining organ is the Pericardium; connecting organ is San Jiao (Triple Energizer) -- an interior-exterior (yin-yang) pair.
- PC has three branches: internal, superficial, and an upper branch; it starts at the chest and runs to the hand.
- The Liver meridian is the only primary meridian that runs across/connects with the external genitalia.
- The Liver meridian connects to the Lung meridian (closing the 12-meridian circulation sequence).
- Both Hand-Shaoyang (SJ) and Foot-Shaoyang (GB) meridians run across the ear and the lateral side of the head -- combine both for lateral headache.
- GB starts at the outer canthus and ends at the tip of the 4th toe.

HOMEWORK 5 (new for this edition -- 2026 deck)

Homework 5 (per 2026 slide deck): a diagram assignment -- draw an assigned vessel's complete course. Graded on 4 criteria (1 point each): accurate start/end points, complete route, correct direction of the route, clarity and proper labeling. Submit one day before the next class.